

Representation of follow-up

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<http://BendixCarstensen.com>

SPE, Tartu, Estonia,

June 2026

<http://BendixCarstensen.com/SPE>

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Bendix Carstensen

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time-split

- ▶ In follow-up studies we estimate rates from:
 - ▶ D — events, deaths
 - ▶ Y — person-years
 - ▶ $\hat{\lambda} = D/Y$ rates
 - ▶ ... empirical counterpart of intensity — an **estimate**
- ▶ Rates differ between persons.
- ▶ Rates differ **within** persons:
 - ▶ by age
 - ▶ by calendar time
 - ▶ by disease duration
 - ▶ ...
- ▶ Multiple timescales.
- ▶ Rates between multiple states (little boxes — later)

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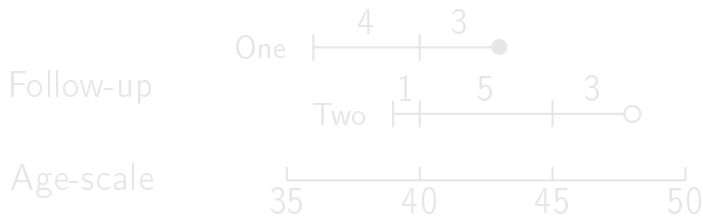
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Stratification by age

If follow-up is rather short, age at entry is OK for age-stratification.

If follow-up is long, stratification by categories of **current age** is preferable.

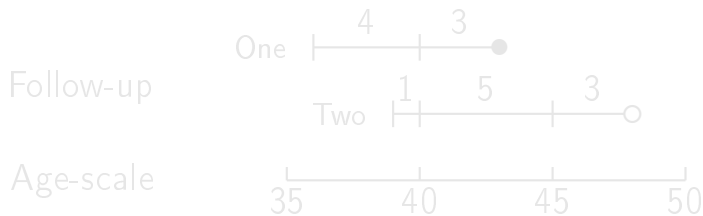


- allowing rates to vary across age-bands
- how do we split follow-up by age and why is it OK?

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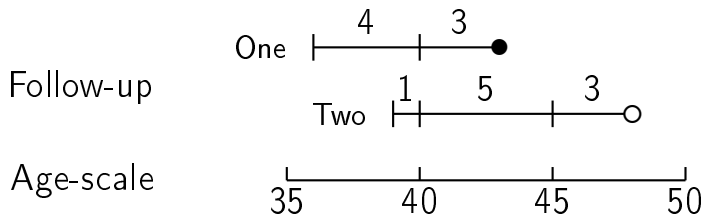


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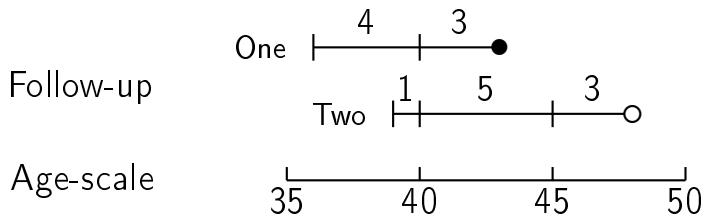


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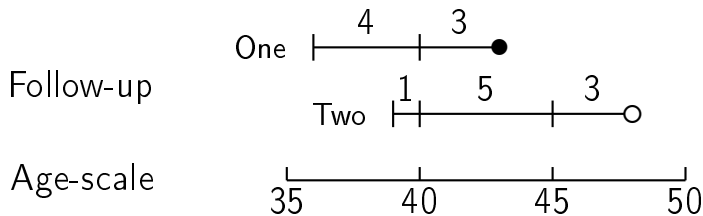
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Statistical model for follow-up data

► Data:

- status and time at entry
- status and time at exit
- ... events (= change of status) and **observed** risk time:
empirical occurrence rates (d, y)

► Model for occurrence rates:

- $\lambda(t, x) = P \{ \text{event in } (t, t + dt] | \text{alive at } t, x \} / dt$
- parametric specification of how λ depends on t and x
- likelihood is a function of λ and data: $P \{ \text{data} | \text{model}, \lambda \}$
- simplest case with constant λ : log-likelihood $= d \log(\lambda) - \lambda y$
- log-likelihood for a Poisson variate d with expectation λy is:
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- rate model is not a Poisson model, but the likelihood is the same

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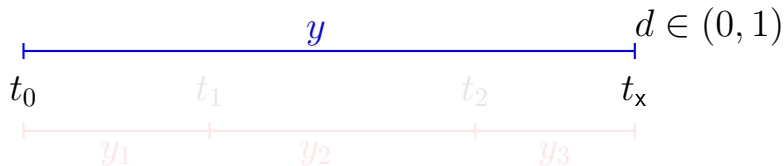
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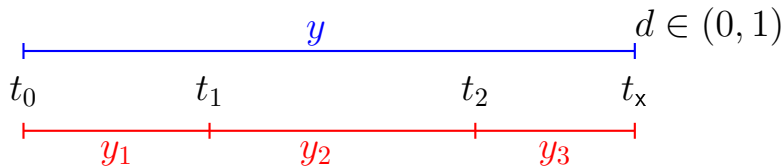
$$P(d \text{ at } t_x | \text{entry } t_0)$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= P(\text{surv } t_0 \rightarrow t_1 | \text{entry } t_0) \\
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 \end{aligned}$$

log-Lik (λ constant)

$$d \log(\lambda) - \lambda y$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= 0 \log(\lambda) - \lambda y_1 \\
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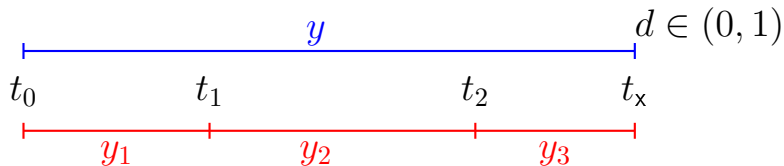
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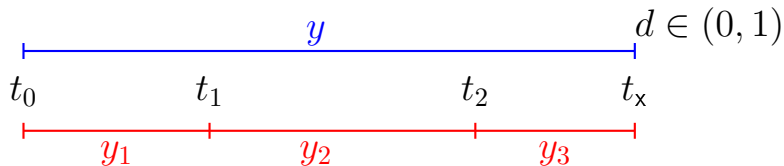
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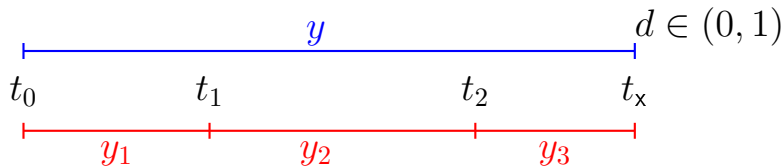
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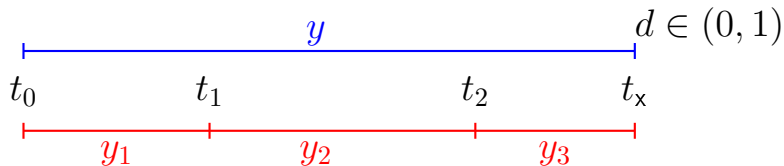
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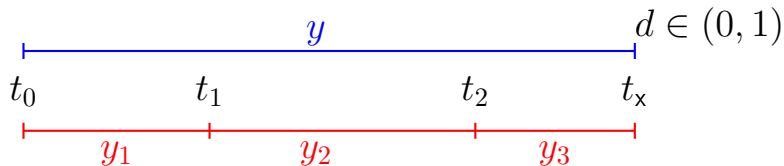
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Probability

log-Lik (λ varies)

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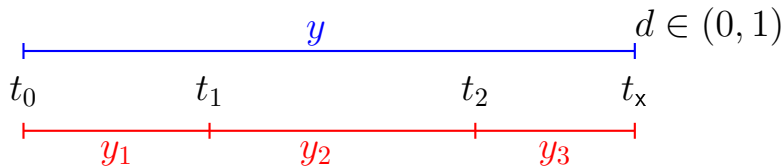
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$$= 0 \log(\lambda_1) - \lambda_1 y_1$$

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—allows different rates (λ_i) **between** intervals,
but assumes constant rates **within** intervals



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Dividing time in small intervals requires:

time scale / origin: date where the time scale is 0:

- ▶ Age — 0 at date of birth
- ▶ Disease duration — 0 at date of diagnosis

Intervals: How should time be subdivided:

- ▶ 1-year classes? 5-year classes? Equal length?
- ▶ —short enough for assumption of constant rate in each interval

Aim: Separate rate in each interval

- mimicking continuous time using short intervals with **constant rate**
- time at the beginning of interval used as **quantitative variable**.

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- ▶ 1-year classes? 5-year classes? Equal length?
- ▶ —short enough for assumption of constant rate in each interval

Aim: Separate rate in each interval

- mimicking continuous time using short intervals with constant rate
- time at the beginning of interval used as quantitative variable.

Dividing time in small intervals requires:

time scale / origin: date where the time scale is 0:

- ▶ Age — 0 at date of birth
- ▶ Disease duration — 0 at date of diagnosis

Intervals: How should time be subdivided:

- ▶ 1-year classes? 5-year classes? Equal length?
- ▶ —short enough for assumption of constant rate in each interval

Aim: Separate rate in each interval

- mimicking continuous time using short intervals with **constant rate**
- time at the beginning of interval used as **quantitative variable**.

Follow-up intervals on several timescales

- ▶ The risk-time is the same on all timescales
- ▶ So only need the **entry** point on each time scale:
 - ▶ Age at entry
 - ▶ Date of entry
 - ▶ Time since diagnosis at entry
 - if time of diagnosis is the entry, this is 0 for all
- ▶ Response variable in analysis of rates:
 (d, y) (event, duration)
- ▶ Covariates in analysis of rates:
 - ▶ timescales
 - ▶ other (fixed) measurements
- ▶ ... do not confuse **duration** and **timescale** !

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 - ▶ **timescales**
 - ▶ other (fixed) measurements
- ▶ ... do not confuse **duration** and **timescale** !

Follow-up data in Epi — Lexis objects I

```
> thoro[1:4,1:8]
```

	id	sex	birthdat	contrast	injecdat	volume	exitdat	exitstat
1	1	2	1916.609	1	1938.791	22	1976.787	1
2	2	2	1927.843	1	1943.906	80	1966.030	1
3	3	1	1902.778	1	1935.629	10	1959.719	1
4	4	1	1918.359	1	1936.396	10	1977.307	1

```
> thL <- Lexis(entry = list(age = injecdat - birthdat,  
+                           dat = injecdat,  
+                           tfi = 0),  
+             exit = list(dat = exitdat),  
+             exit.status = factor(exitstat == 1,  
+                                 labels = c("Alive", "Dead")),  
+             data = thoro)
```

NOTE: entry.status has been set to "Alive" for all.

NOTE: Dropping 2 rows with duration of follow up < tol

Follow-up data in Epi — Lexis objects II

```
> summary(thL, timeScales = TRUE)
```

Transitions:

To

From	Alive	Dead	Records:	Events:	Risk time:	Persons:
Alive	504	1964	2468	1964	51934.08	2468

Timescales:

age	dat	tfi
""	""	""

Definition of Lexis object

```
thL <- Lexis(entry = list(age = injeccat - birthdat,  
                          dat = injeccat,  
                          tfi = 0),  
            exit = list(dat = exitdat),  
            exit.status = factor(exitstat == 1,  
                                labels = c("Alive", "Dead")),  
            data = thoro)
```

entry is defined on **three** timescales,

but exit is only needed on **one** timescale (or vice versa):

Follow-up time is the same on all timescales: $\text{exitdat} - \text{injeccat}$

One element of **entry** and **exit** must have same name (here, **dat**).

Definition of Lexis object

```
thL <- Lexis(entry = list(age = injecdat - birthdat,  
                           dat = injecdat,  
                           tfi = 0),  
             exit = list(dat = exitdat),  
             exit.status = factor(exitstat == 1,  
                                   labels = c("Alive", "Dead")),  
             data = thoro)
```

entry is defined on **three** timescales,

but exit is only needed on **one** timescale (or vice versa):

Follow-up time is the same on all timescales: $\text{exitdat} - \text{injecdat}$

One element of **entry** and **exit** must have same name (here, **dat**).

Definition of Lexis object

```
thL <- Lexis(entry = list(age = injeccat - birthdat,  
                          dat = injeccat,  
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            exit = list(dat = exitdat),  
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thL <- Lexis(entry = list(age = injeccat - birthdat,  
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                                   labels = c("Alive", "Dead")),  
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```

entry is defined on **three** timescales,

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Follow-up time is the same on all timescales: `exitdat - injeccat`

One element of `entry` and `exit` must have same name (here, `dat`).

Definition of Lexis object

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thL <- Lexis(entry = list(age = injecdat - birthdat,  
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One element of `entry` and `exit` must have same name (here, `dat`).

The looks of a Lexis object

```
> thL[1:4,1:9]
      age      dat tfi lex.dur lex.Cst lex.Xst lex.id
1 22.18 1938.79   0   37.99   Alive   Dead     1
2 49.54 1945.77   0   18.59   Alive   Dead     2
3 68.20 1955.18   0    1.40   Alive   Dead     3
4 20.80 1957.61   0   34.52   Alive   Alive     4
...

> summary(thL)
Transitions:
      To
From Alive Dead Records: Events: Risk time: Persons:
      0   504 1964      2468      1964      51934.08      2468
```

The looks of a Lexis object

```
> thL[1:4,1:9]
```

	age	dat	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst	lex.id
1	22.18	1938.79	0	37.99	Alive	Dead	1
2	49.54	1945.77	0	18.59	Alive	Dead	2
3	68.20	1955.18	0	1.40	Alive	Dead	3
4	20.80	1957.61	0	34.52	Alive	Alive	4

...

```
> summary(thL)
```

Transitions:

	To
From	Alive
From	Dead
Records:	
0	504
1964	2468
Events:	1964
Risk time:	51934.08
Persons:	2468

The looks of a Lexis object

```
> thL[1:4,1:9]
```

	age	dat	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst	lex.id
1	22.18	1938.79	0	37.99	Alive	Dead	1
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...

```
> summary(thL)
```

Transitions:

	To						
From	Alive	Dead	Records:	Events:	Risk time:	Persons:	
	0	504	1964	2468	1964	51934.08	2468

The looks of a Lexis object

```
> thL[1:4,1:9]
      age      dat tfi lex.dur lex.Cst lex.Xst lex.id
1 22.18 1938.79   0   37.99   Alive   Dead     1
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4 20.80 1957.61   0   34.52   Alive  Alive     4
...
```

```
> summary(thL)
```

Transitions:

To

From	Alive	Dead	Records:	Events:	Risk time:	Persons:
0	504	1964	2468	1964	51934.08	2468

The looks of a Lexis object

```
> thL[1:4,1:9]
```

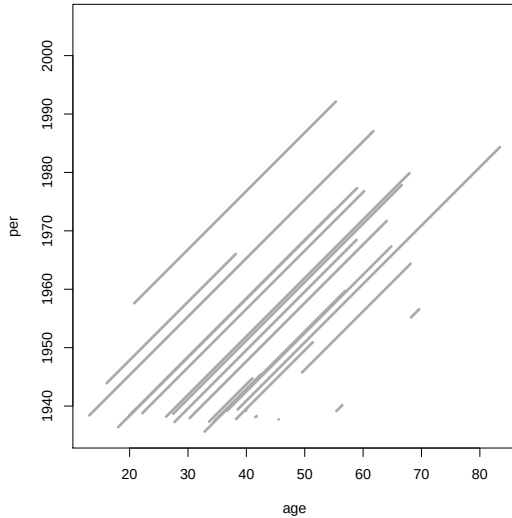
	age	dat	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst	lex.id
1	22.18	1938.79	0	37.99	Alive	Dead	1
2	49.54	1945.77	0	18.59	Alive	Dead	2
3	68.20	1955.18	0	1.40	Alive	Dead	3
4	20.80	1957.61	0	34.52	Alive	Alive	4

...

```
> summary(thL)
```

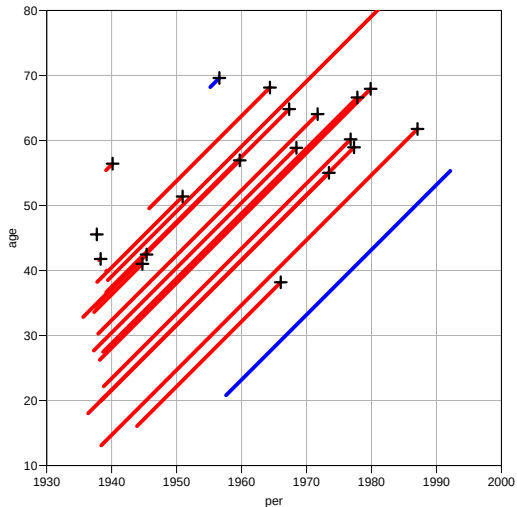
Transitions:

	To					
From	Alive	Dead	Records:	Events:	Risk time:	Persons:
0	504	1964	2468	1964	51934.08	2468



```
> plot( thL, lwd=3 )
```

Representation of follow-up (time-split)



Lexis diagram

```
> plot(thL, 2:1, lwd=5, col=c("red", "blue")[thL$contrast],
+      grid = TRUE, lty.grid = 1, col.grid = gray(0.7),
+      xlim = 1930 + c(0,70), xaxs = "i", ylim = 10 +c(0, 70), yaxs = "i", las = 1 )
> points( thL, 2:1, pch=c(NA,3)[thL$lex.Xst], lwd = 3, cex = 1.5 )
```

EINLEITUNG
IN DIE
THEORIE
DER
BEVÖLKERUNGSSTATISTIK

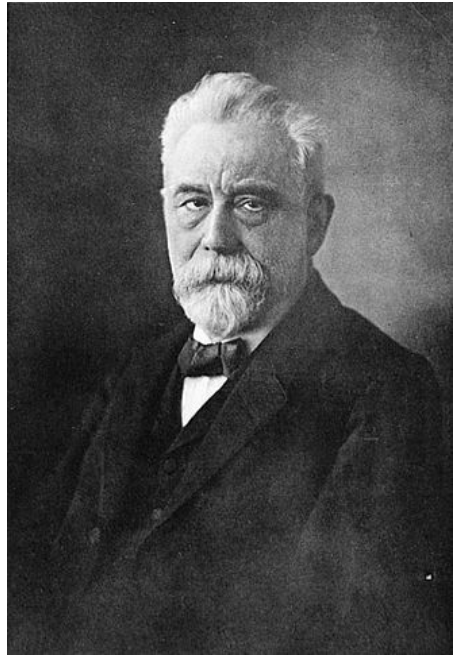
VON

W. LEXIS

DR. DER STAATSWISSENSCHAFTEN UND DER PHILOSOPHIE,
O. PROFESSOR DER STATISTIK IN DORPAT.

STRASSBURG

KARL J. TRÜBNER



Splitting follow-up time

```
> spl1 <- splitLexis(thL, time.scale = "age", breaks = seq(0, 100, 20))
> round(spl1, 1)
```

age	dat	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst	lex.id	sex	birthdat	contrast	injecdat	vo
22.2	1938.8	0.0	17.8	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
40.0	1956.6	17.8	20.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
60.0	1976.6	37.8	0.2	0	1	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
49.5	1945.8	0.0	10.5	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	1945.8	
60.0	1956.2	10.5	8.1	0	1	640	2	1896.2	1	1945.8	
68.2	1955.2	0.0	1.4	0	1	3425	1	1887.0	2	1955.2	
20.8	1957.6	0.0	19.2	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	1957.6	
40.0	1976.8	19.2	15.3	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	1957.6	
...											

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22.2	1938.8	0.0	17.8	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
40.0	1956.6	17.8	20.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
60.0	1976.6	37.8	0.2	0	1	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
49.5	1945.8	0.0	10.5	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	1945.8	
60.0	1956.2	10.5	8.1	0	1	640	2	1896.2	1	1945.8	
68.2	1955.2	0.0	1.4	0	1	3425	1	1887.0	2	1955.2	
20.8	1957.6	0.0	19.2	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	1957.6	
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40.0	1956.6	17.8	20.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
60.0	1976.6	37.8	0.2	0	1	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
49.5	1945.8	0.0	10.5	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	1945.8	
60.0	1956.2	10.5	8.1	0	1	640	2	1896.2	1	1945.8	
68.2	1955.2	0.0	1.4	0	1	3425	1	1887.0	2	1955.2	
20.8	1957.6	0.0	19.2	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	1957.6	
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40.0	1956.6	17.8	20.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
60.0	1976.6	37.8	0.2	0	1	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
49.5	1945.8	0.0	10.5	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	1945.8	
60.0	1956.2	10.5	8.1	0	1	640	2	1896.2	1	1945.8	
68.2	1955.2	0.0	1.4	0	1	3425	1	1887.0	2	1955.2	
20.8	1957.6	0.0	19.2	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	1957.6	
40.0	1976.8	19.2	15.3	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	1957.6	
...											

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```

age	dat	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst	lex.id	sex	birthdat	contrast	injecdat	vo
22.2	1938.8	0.0	17.8	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
40.0	1956.6	17.8	20.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
60.0	1976.6	37.8	0.2	0	1	1	2	1916.6	1	1938.8	
49.5	1945.8	0.0	10.5	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	1945.8	
60.0	1956.2	10.5	8.1	0	1	640	2	1896.2	1	1945.8	
68.2	1955.2	0.0	1.4	0	1	3425	1	1887.0	2	1955.2	
20.8	1957.6	0.0	19.2	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	1957.6	
40.0	1976.8	19.2	15.3	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	1957.6	
...											

Split on another timescale

```
> spl2 <- splitLexis( spl1, time.scale="tfi", breaks=c(0,1,5,20,100) )  
> round( spl2, 1 )
```

	lex.id	age	dat	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst	id	sex	birthdat	contrast	inje
1	1	22.2	1938.8	0.0	1.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
2	1	23.2	1939.8	1.0	4.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
3	1	27.2	1943.8	5.0	12.8	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
4	1	40.0	1956.6	17.8	2.2	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
5	1	42.2	1958.8	20.0	17.8	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
6	1	60.0	1976.6	37.8	0.2	0	1	1	2	1916.6	1	19
7	2	49.5	1945.8	0.0	1.0	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	19
8	2	50.5	1946.8	1.0	4.0	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	19
9	2	54.5	1950.8	5.0	5.5	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	19
10	2	60.0	1956.2	10.5	8.1	0	1	640	2	1896.2	1	19
11	3	68.2	1955.2	0.0	1.0	0	0	3425	1	1887.0	2	19
12	3	69.2	1956.2	1.0	0.4	0	1	3425	1	1887.0	2	19
13	4	20.8	1957.6	0.0	1.0	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	19
14	4	21.8	1958.6	1.0	4.0	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	19
15	4	25.8	1962.6	5.0	14.2	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	19
16	4	40.0	1976.8	19.2	0.8	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	19
17	4	40.8	1977.6	20.0	14.5	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	19

Split on another timescale

```
> spl2 <- splitLexis( spl1, time.scale="tfi", breaks=c(0,1,5,20,100) )  
> round( spl2, 1 )
```

	lex.id	age	dat	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst	id	sex	birthdat	contrast	inj
1	1	22.2	1938.8	0.0	1.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
2	1	23.2	1939.8	1.0	4.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
3	1	27.2	1943.8	5.0	12.8	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
4	1	40.0	1956.6	17.8	2.2	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
5	1	42.2	1958.8	20.0	17.8	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
6	1	60.0	1976.6	37.8	0.2	0	1	1	2	1916.6	1	19
7	2	49.5	1945.8	0.0	1.0	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	19
8	2	50.5	1946.8	1.0	4.0	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	19
9	2	54.5	1950.8	5.0	5.5	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	19
10	2	60.0	1956.2	10.5	8.1	0	1	640	2	1896.2	1	19
11	3	68.2	1955.2	0.0	1.0	0	0	3425	1	1887.0	2	19
12	3	69.2	1956.2	1.0	0.4	0	1	3425	1	1887.0	2	19
13	4	20.8	1957.6	0.0	1.0	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	19
14	4	21.8	1958.6	1.0	4.0	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	19
15	4	25.8	1962.6	5.0	14.2	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	19
16	4	40.0	1976.8	19.2	0.8	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	19
17	4	40.8	1977.6	20.0	14.5	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	19

Split on another timescale

```
> spl2 <- splitLexis( spl1, time.scale="tfi", breaks=c(0,1,5,20,100) )  
> round( spl2, 1 )
```

	lex.id	age	dat	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst	id	sex	birthdat	contrast	inje
1	1	22.2	1938.8	0.0	1.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
2	1	23.2	1939.8	1.0	4.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
3	1	27.2	1943.8	5.0	12.8	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
4	1	40.0	1956.6	17.8	2.2	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
5	1	42.2	1958.8	20.0	17.8	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
6	1	60.0	1976.6	37.8	0.2	0	1	1	2	1916.6	1	19
7	2	49.5	1945.8	0.0	1.0	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	19
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Split on another timescale

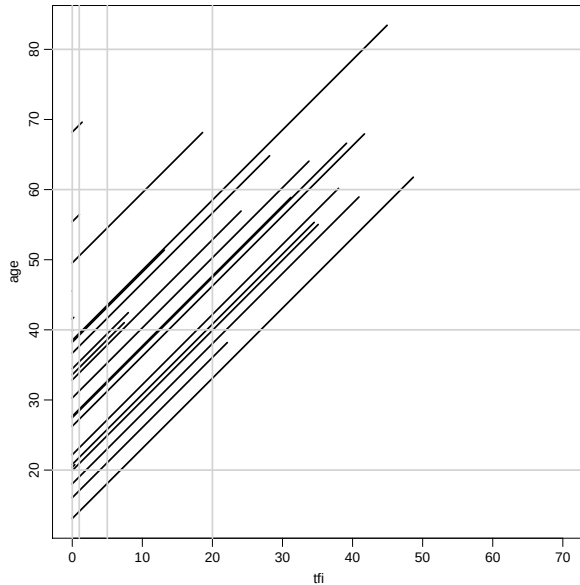
```
> spl2 <- splitLexis( spl1, time.scale="tfi", breaks=c(0,1,5,20,100) )  
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```

	lex.id	age	dat	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst	id	sex	birthdat	contrast	inje
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3	1	27.2	1943.8	5.0	12.8	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
4	1	40.0	1956.6	17.8	2.2	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
5	1	42.2	1958.8	20.0	17.8	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
6	1	60.0	1976.6	37.8	0.2	0	1	1	2	1916.6	1	19
7	2	49.5	1945.8	0.0	1.0	0	0	640	2	1896.2	1	19
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10	2	60.0	1956.2	10.5	8.1	0	1	640	2	1896.2	1	19
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16	4	40.0	1976.8	19.2	0.8	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	19
17	4	40.8	1977.6	20.0	14.5	0	0	4017	2	1936.8	2	19

Split on another timescale

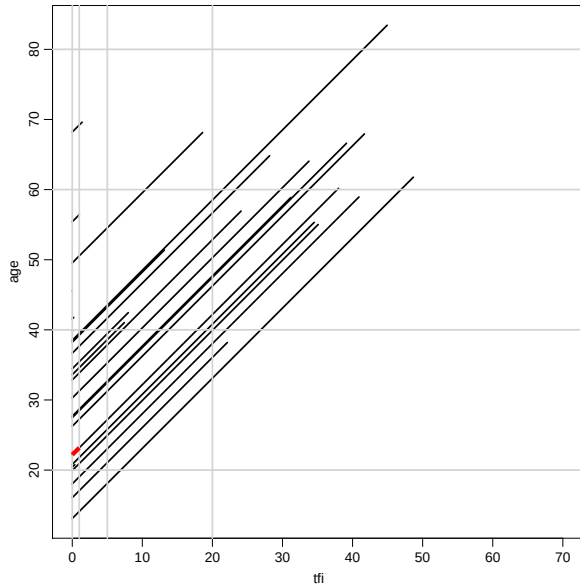
```
> spl2 <- splitLexis( spl1, time.scale="tfi", breaks=c(0,1,5,20,100) )  
> round( spl2, 1 )
```

	lex.id	age	dat	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst	id	sex	birthdat	contrast	inje
1	1	22.2	1938.8	0.0	1.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
2	1	23.2	1939.8	1.0	4.0	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
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5	1	42.2	1958.8	20.0	17.8	0	0	1	2	1916.6	1	19
6	1	60.0	1976.6	37.8	0.2	0	1	1	2	1916.6	1	19
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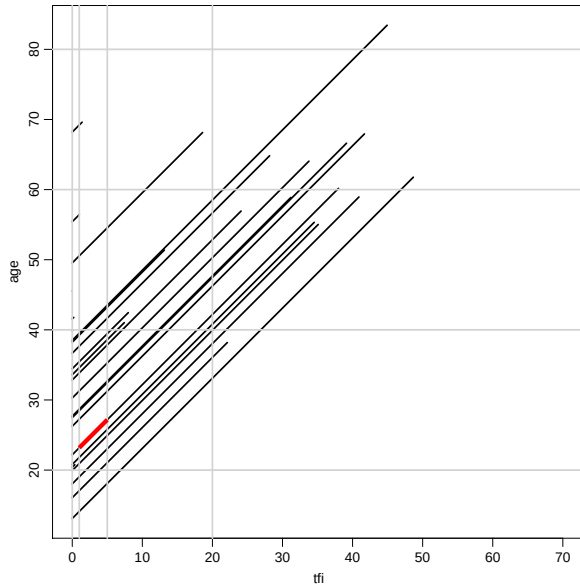
age	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst
22.2	0.0	1.0	0	0
23.2	1.0	4.0	0	0
27.2	5.0	12.8	0	0
40.0	17.8	2.2	0	0
42.2	20.0	17.8	0	0
60.0	37.8	0.2	0	1

```
plot(spl2, c(1, 3), col = "black", lwd = 2)
```



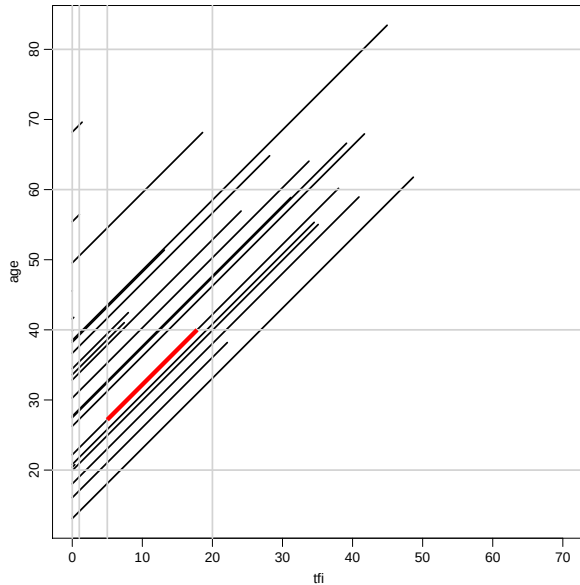
age	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst
22.2	0.0	1.0	0	0
23.2	1.0	4.0	0	0
27.2	5.0	12.8	0	0
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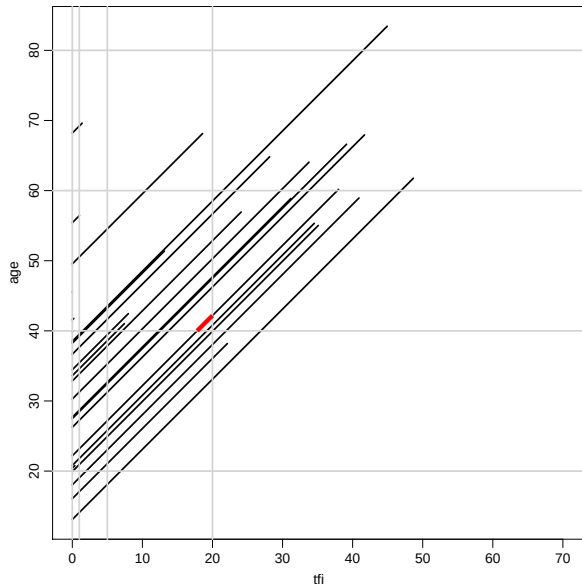
age	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst
22.2	0.0	1.0	0	0
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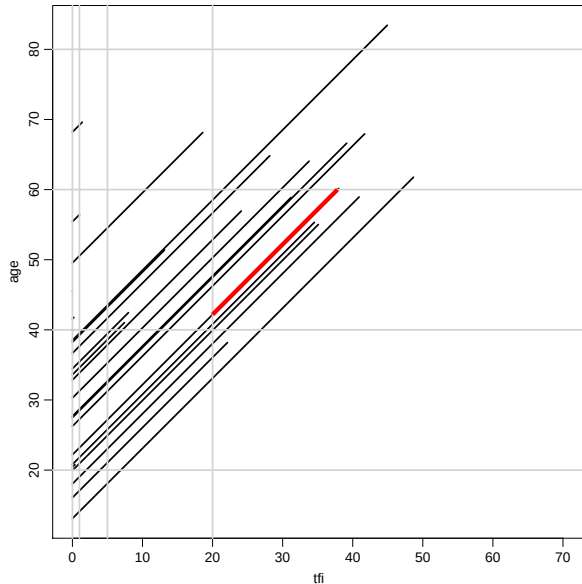
age	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst
22.2	0.0	1.0	0	0
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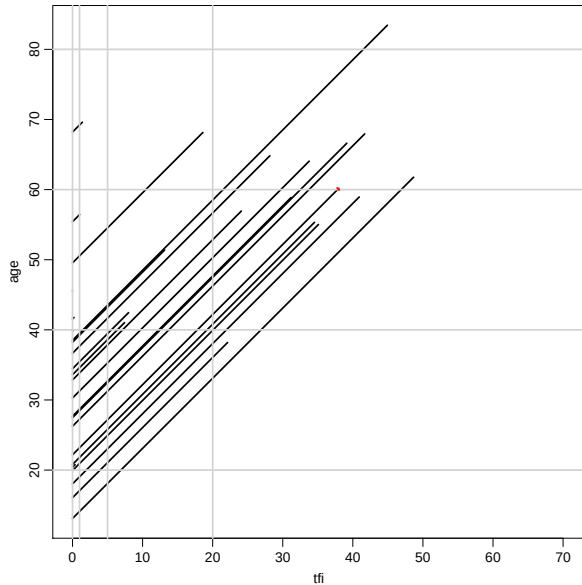
age	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst
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60.0	37.8	0.2	0	1

```
plot(spl2, c(1, 3), col = "black", lwd = 2)
```

Splitting on several timescales

```
> spl1 <- splitLexis(thL , time.scale = "age", breaks = seq(0, 100, 20))
> spl2 <- splitLexis(spl1, time.scale = "tfi", breaks = c(0, 1, 5, 20, 100))
> summary(spl2)
```

Transitions:

To

From	Alive	Dead	Records:	Events:	Risk time:	Persons:
Alive	8250	1964	10214	1964	51934.08	2468

```
> library(popEpi)
> splx <- splitMulti(thL, age = seq(0, 100, 20),
+                   tfi = c(0, 1, 5, 20, 100))
> summary(splx)
```

Transitions:

To

From	Alive	Dead	Records:	Events:	Risk time:	Persons:
Alive	8248	1964	10212	1964	51916.98	2468

```
> # NOTE: splitMulti excludes follow-up outside range of breaks
```

Likelihood for time-split data

- ▶ We assume that rates are constant in each (small) interval
- ▶ Each observation in the dataset represents an interval, contributing a term to the (log-)likelihood for the rate
- ▶ Each **term** looks like a contribution from a Poisson variate (albeit with values only 0 or 1)
- ▶ So the likelihood from a single **person** looks like the likelihood from several independent Poisson variates
- ▶ ...but the data are **neither** independent **nor** Poisson

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Analysis of time-split data

Observations (records) classified by p —person and i —interval

- ▶ d_{pi} — events: `lex.Xst=="Dead" & lex.Xst!=lex.Cst`
- ▶ y_{pi} — risk time: `lex.dur` (duration)
- ▶ Covariates are:
 - ▶ timescales (age, period, time since entry)
 - ▶ other variables for this person (constant in each interval).
- ▶ Rate likelihood for **one person** is identical to a Poisson likelihood for **many independent** Poisson variates
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Fitting a simple model—data:

```
> stat.table(contrast,
+             list(D = sum(lex.Xst == "Dead"),
+                   Y = sum(lex.dur),
+                   Rate = ratio(lex.Xst == "Dead", lex.dur, 100)),
+             margin = TRUE,
+             data = spl2)
```

contrast	D	Y	Rate
1	928.00	20094.74	4.62
2	1036.00	31839.35	3.25
Total	1964.00	51934.08	3.78

Fitting a simple model with poisson

contrast	D	Y	Rate
1	928.00	20094.74	4.62
2	1036.00	31839.35	3.25

```
> m0 <- glm((lex.Xst == "Dead") ~ factor(contrast) - 1,  
+           offset = log(lex.dur / 100),  
+           family = poisson,  
+           data = spl2)  
> round(ci.exp(m0), 2)
```

	exp(Est.)	2.5%	97.5%
factor(contrast)1	4.62	4.33	4.93
factor(contrast)2	3.25	3.06	3.46

... a Poisson model for mortality using log-person-years as offset

Fitting a simple model with `poisreg`

contrast	D	Y	Rate
1	928.00	20094.74	4.62
2	1036.00	31839.35	3.25

```
> m0 <- glm(cbind(lex.Xst == "Dead", lex.dur / 100) ~ factor(contrast) - 1,  
+           family = poisreg,  
+           data = spl2)  
> round(ci.exp(m0), 2)
```

	exp(Est.)	2.5%	97.5%
factor(contrast)1	4.62	4.33	4.93
factor(contrast)2	3.25	3.06	3.46

... a Poisson model for mortality rates based on deaths and person-years

Fitting a simple model with `glmLexis`

The wrapper `glmLexis` requires that `lex.Cst` and `lex.Xst` are factors — see `factorize`:

```
> m0 <- glmLexis(spl2, ~ factor(contrast) - 1, scale = 100)
stats::glm Poisson analysis of Lexis object spl2 with log link:
Rates for the transition:
Alive->Dead
, lex.dur (person-time) scaled by 100
> round(ci.exp(m0), 2)
```

	exp(Est.)	2.5%	97.5%
factor(contrast)1	4.62	4.33	4.93
factor(contrast)2	3.25	3.06	3.46

... a Poisson model for mortality rates based on deaths and person-years in a `Lexis` object

Fitting a simple model — aggregate data

contrast	D	Y	Rate
1	928.00	20094.74	4.62
2	1036.00	31839.35	3.25

As long as we only use covariates that take only a few values, we can model the aggregate data directly:

```
> mx <- glm(cbind(c( 928 , 1036 ),  
+                 c(20094.74, 31839.35) / 100) ~ factor(1:2) - 1,  
+          family = poisreg )  
> round(ci.exp(mx), 2)
```

	exp(Est.)	2.5%	97.5%
factor(1:2)1	4.62	4.33	4.93
factor(1:2)2	3.25	3.06	3.46

SMR

Bendix Carstensen

Representation of follow-up

SPE, Tartu, Estonia,

June 2026

<http://BendixCarstensen.com/SPE>

Cohorts where all are exposed

When there is no comparison group we may ask:

Do mortality rates in cohort differ from those of an **external** population, for example:

Rates from:

- ▶ Occupational cohorts
- ▶ Patient cohorts

compared with reference rates obtained from:

- ▶ Population statistics (mortality rates)
- ▶ Hospital registers (disease rates)

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Cohort rates vs. population rates: SMR

- ▶ **Multiplicative:** $\lambda(a) = \theta \times \lambda_p(a)$
- ▶ Cohort rates proportional to reference rates, λ_p :
 $\lambda(a) = \theta \times \lambda_p(a)$ — θ the same in all age-bands.
- ▶ D_a deaths during Y_a person-years in age-band a gives the likelihood:

$$\begin{aligned} D_a \log(\lambda(a)) - \lambda(a) Y_a &= D_a \log(\theta \lambda_p(a)) - \theta \lambda_p(a) Y_a \\ &= D_a \log(\theta) + D_a \log(\lambda_p(a)) - \theta (\lambda_p(a) Y_a) \end{aligned}$$

- ▶ The constant $D_a \log(\lambda_p(a))$ does not involve θ , and so can be dropped.

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- ▶ The constant $D_a \log(\lambda_p(a))$ does not involve θ , and so can be dropped.

- ▶ $\lambda_p(a)Y_a = E_a$ is the “expected” number of cases in age a , so the log-likelihood contribution from age a is:

$$D_a \log(\theta) - \theta(\lambda_p(a)Y_a) = D_a \log(\theta) - \theta(E_a)$$

- ▶ The log-likelihood is similar to the log-likelihood for a rate, just with Y replaced by E , so:

$$\hat{\theta} = \sum_a D_a / \sum_a E_a = \text{Observed/Expected} = \text{SMR}$$

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Modeling the SMR in practice

- ▶ As for the rates, the SMR can be modelled using interval data.
- ▶ First column of response is d_i , the event indicator (`lex.Xst`).
- ▶ Second column the expected value for each piece of follow-up, $e_i = y_i \times \lambda_p$ (`lex.dur * rate`)
- ▶ λ_p is the population rate corresponding to the age, period and sex of the follow-up period y_i .

Modeling the SMR in practice

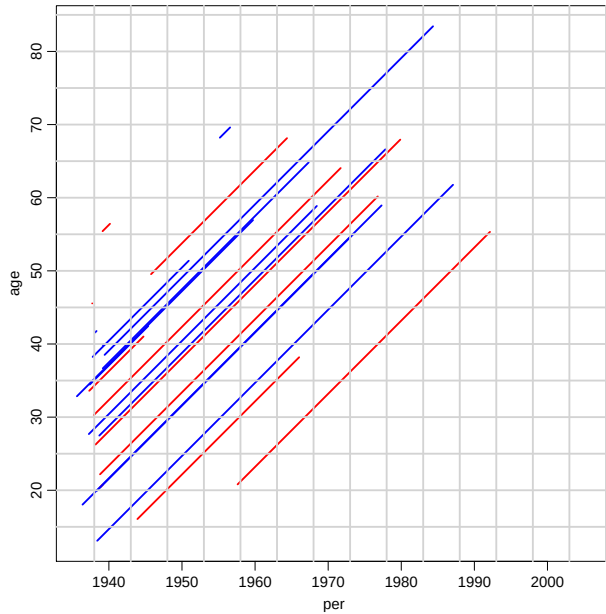
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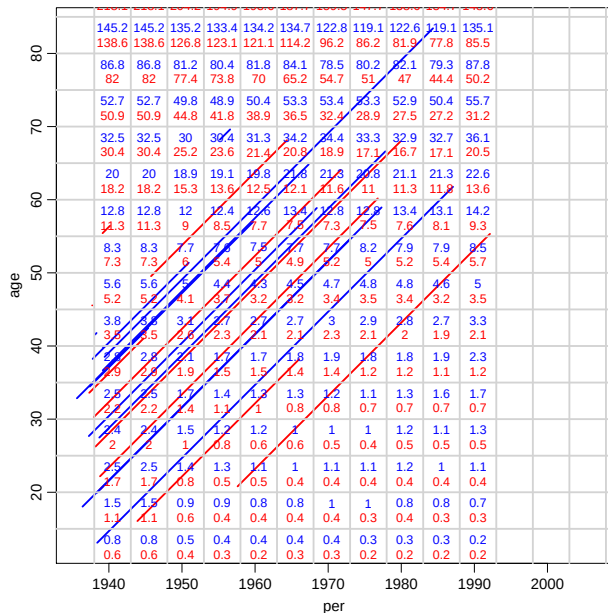
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Split the data to fit with population data

```
> thad <- splitMulti(thL, age=seq(0,90,5), dte=seq(1938,2038,5) )  
> summary( thad )
```

Transitions:

To

```
From      0      1 Records: Events: Risk time: Persons:  
      0 21059 1939      22998      1939      51787.96      2463
```

Create variables to fit with the population data

```
> thad$agr <- timeBand( thad, "age", "left" )  
> thad$per <- timeBand( thad, "dte", "left" )  
> round( thad[1:5,c("lex.id","age","agr","dte","per","lex.dur","lex.Xst","sex")],
```

lex.id	age	dte	lex.dur	lex.Xst	agr	per	sex
1	22.18	1938.79	2.82	0	20	1938	2
1	25.00	1941.61	1.39	0	25	1938	2
1	26.39	1943.00	3.61	0	25	1943	2
1	30.00	1946.61	1.39	0	30	1943	2
1	31.39	1948.00	3.61	0	30	1948	2

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```

lex.id	age	dte	lex.dur	lex.Xst	agr	per	sex
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1	30.00	1946.61	1.39	0	30	1943	2
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```

> data( gmortDK )
> dim( gmortDK )

[1] 418  21

> gmortDK[1:6,1:6]
      agr per sex   risk    dt    rt
1     0  38   1 996019 14079 14.135
2     5  38   1 802334   726  0.905
3    10  38   1 753017   600  0.797
4    15  38   1 773393  1167  1.509
5    20  38   1 813882  2031  2.495
6    25  38   1 789990  1862  2.357

> gmortDK$per <- gmortDK$per+1900
> thadx <- merge( thad, gmortDK[,c("agr","per","sex","rt")] )
> thadx$E <- thadx$lex.dur * thadx$rt / 1000

```

contrast	D	Y	E	SMR
1	917.00	20045.46	214.66	4.27
2	1022.00	31742.51	447.21	2.29

```
> m.SMR <- glm(cbind(lex.Xst, E) ~ factor(contrast) - 1,
+             family = poisreg,
+             data = thadx)
> round(ci.exp(m.SMR), 2)
```

	exp(Est.)	2.5%	97.5%
factor(contrast)1	4.27	4.00	4.56
factor(contrast)2	2.29	2.15	2.43

- Analysis of SMR is like analysis of rates:
- Replace Y with E — that's all! (`glmLexis` not usable)
- ...it's the calculation of E that is difficult

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Representation of follow-up

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Cohort rates vs. population rates: RSR

► **Additive:** $\lambda(a) = \delta(a) + \lambda_p(a)$, λ_p assumed known

► Note that the survival (since $a = a_0$, say) is:

$$\begin{aligned} S(a) &= \exp\left(-\int_{a_0}^a \delta(a) + \lambda_p(a) da\right) \\ &= \exp\left(-\int_{a_0}^a \delta(a) da\right) \times \exp\left(-\int_{a_0}^a \lambda_p(a) da\right) \end{aligned}$$

$$\Rightarrow r(a) = S(a)/S_p(a) = \exp\left(-\int_{a_0}^a \delta(a) da\right)$$

► Additive model for rates $\Leftrightarrow$ Relative survival model.

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- ▶ **Additive** model for **rates** $\Leftrightarrow$ **Relative survival** model.

Split the data to fit with population data

```
> data( thoro )
> thoro <- cal.yr(thoro)
> thL <- Lexis(entry = list(age = injecdat - birthdat,
+                           dte = injecdat,
+                           tfi = 0),
+             exit = list(dte = exitdat),
+             exit.status = as.numeric(exitstat == 1),
+             data = thoro)
```

NOTE: entry.status has been set to 0 for all.

NOTE: Dropping 2 rows with duration of follow up < tol

```
> thad <- splitMulti(thL, age = seq(0, 90, 5), dte = seq(1938, 2038, 5))
> thad$agr <- timeBand(thad, "age", "left")
> thad$per <- timeBand(thad, "dte", "left")
> thad[1:5, c(lexVars(thad), "agr", "per", "sex")]
```

lex.id	age	dte	tfi	lex.dur	lex.Cst	lex.Xst	agr	per	sex
1	22.18	1938.79	0.00	2.82	0	0	20	1938	2
1	25.00	1941.61	2.82	1.39	0	0	25	1938	2
1	26.39	1943.00	4.21	3.61	0	0	25	1943	2
1	30.00	1946.61	7.82	1.39	0	0	30	1943	2
1	31.39	1948.00	9.21	3.61	0	0	30	1948	2

Important to have rates in correct dimension

```
> data(gmortDK)
> gmortDK[1:3, 1:6]

  agr per sex  risk    dt    rt
1   0  38   1 996019 14079 14.135
2   5  38   1 802334   726  0.905
3  10  38   1 753017   600  0.797

> gmortDK <- mutate(gmortDK, per = per + 1900,
+                    rt = rt / 1000) # rates per 1 year
> thadx <- merge( thad, gmortDK[,c("agr","per","sex","rt")] )
> thadx <- mutate( thadx, E = lex.dur * rt )
```

Additive excess rate model—data

```
> (stat.table( contrast,
+             list(D = sum(lex.Xst),
+                   Y = sum(lex.dur),
+                   Rate = ratio(lex.Xst, lex.dur, 100),
+                   E = sum(E),
+                   Erate = ratio(E, lex.dur, 100),
+                   SMR = ratio(lex.Xst, E)),
+             data = thadx ) -> zz)
```

contrast	D	Y	Rate	E	Erate	SMR
1	917.00	20045.46	4.57	214.66	1.07	4.27
2	1022.00	31742.51	3.22	447.21	1.41	2.29

```
> round(cbind(cohR = zz["Rate", ], popR = zz["Erate", ],
+             excR = zz["Rate", ] - zz["Erate", ]), 2)
```

	cohR	popR	excR
1	4.57	1.07	3.50
2	3.22	1.41	1.81

Simple additive model

A model where the **difference** between the cohort and the population rates are the parameters.

Poisson model with identity link and the expected numbers as offset
... not easy to fit:

```
> try(  
+ glm(cbind(lex.Xst == 1, lex.dur) ~ factor(contrast) - 1,  
+      offset = E,  
+      family = poisreg(link = "identity"),  
+      data = thadx) ) ; geterrmessage() ; warnings()  
[1] "Error : no valid set of coefficients has been found: please supply starting values"  
Advarselsbesked:  
In log(y/mu) : NaNs produced
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```
[1] "Error : no valid set of coefficients has been found: please supply starting "
```

```
Advarselsbesked:
```

```
In log(y/mu) : NaNs produced
```

Additive excess rate model

```
> # start without offset
> glm(cbind(lex.Xst == 1, lex.dur) ~ factor(contrast) - 1,
+     family = poisreg(link = "identity"),
+     data = thadx) -> m0
> #
> # add offset and use starting values from simple model
> update(m0, offset = E,
+       start = coef(m0)) -> mE
> round(ci.lin(mE), 4)
```

	Estimate	StdErr	z	P	2.5%	97.5%
factor(contrast)1	0.0310	0.0015	20.0661	0	0.0280	0.0340
factor(contrast)2	0.0179	0.0010	17.1888	0	0.0158	0.0199

```
> round(ci.exp(mE, Exp = FALSE) * 100, 1) # excess mortality in %/year
```

	Estimate	2.5%	97.5%
factor(contrast)1	3.1	2.8	3.4
factor(contrast)2	1.8	1.6	2.0

Additive excess rate model—estimates

```
> round(ci.exp(mE, Exp = FALSE) * 100, 2) # excess mortality in %/year
```

	Estimate	2.5%	97.5%
factor(contrast)1	3.10	2.80	3.40
factor(contrast)2	1.79	1.58	1.99

```
> round(cbind(cohR = zz["Rate", ],  
+             popR = zz["Erate", ],  
+             excR = zz["Rate", ] - zz["Erate", ]), 2)
```

	cohR	popR	excR
1	4.57	1.07	3.50
2	3.22	1.41	1.81

Not identical estimates, because the model is with `identity` link—not the canonical link for the Poisson distribution.

For `contrast=1` the excess rate is 3.1 per 100 PY

For `contrast=2` the excess rate is 1.8 per 100 PY